4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: March 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

March 2026 Locked March 2026 is locked (closed 2 Apr 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 42.2% gross margin in March: maintenance contracts the most (63.9%), installations the least (34.9%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

March's jobs made $90,236 gross margin (42.2%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $23,895 and overheads $59,200, leaving $7,141 profit before tax (3.3% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 38.9% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$90,236
Technician wages and on-costs	$79,587
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$55,692
Technician time not charged to jobs	$23,895
Gross profit (the P&L)	$66,341
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,200
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$7,141
Revenue	$213,578
Gross margin on jobs, %	42.2%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.3%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**38.9%**

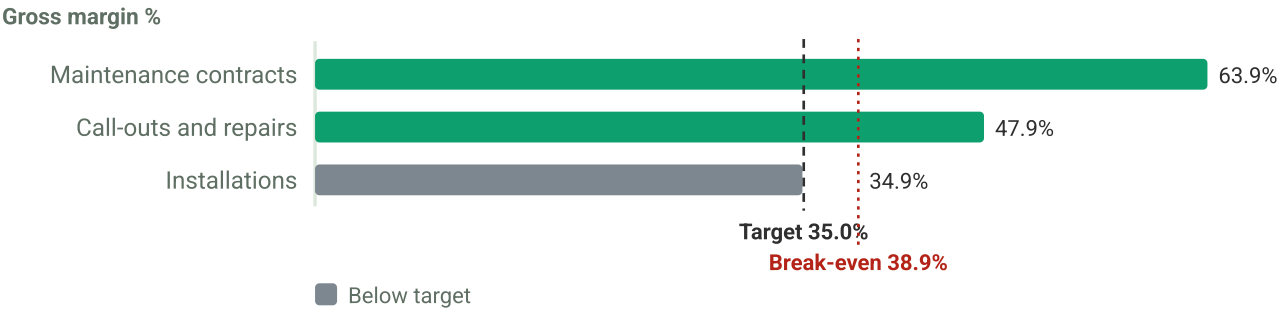
Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, March · All jobs
42.2%
target 35.0%

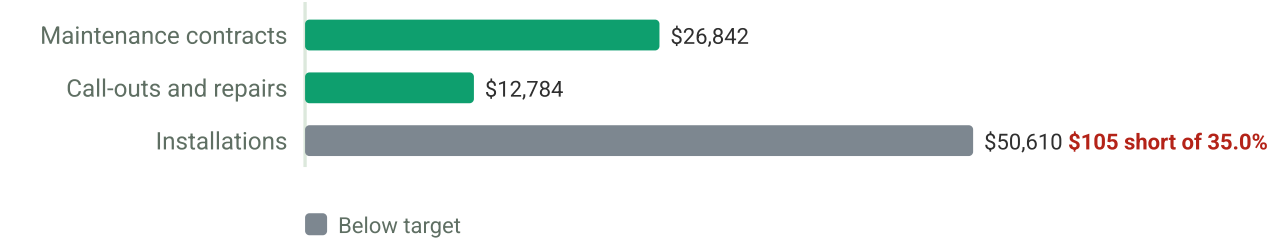
Job gross margin, February · All jobs
44.9%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
38.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (March)

Job gross margin by type of job, March 2026



Gross margin $



What it shows

In March maintenance contracts made a 63.9% job gross margin, installations made a 34.9% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 47.9% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 38.9% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 34.9% gross margin, 0.1 points under the 35.0% target: about $105 on $144,900 of revenue in March. It's below the 38.9% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($12,142 ahead on $42,000 in March).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

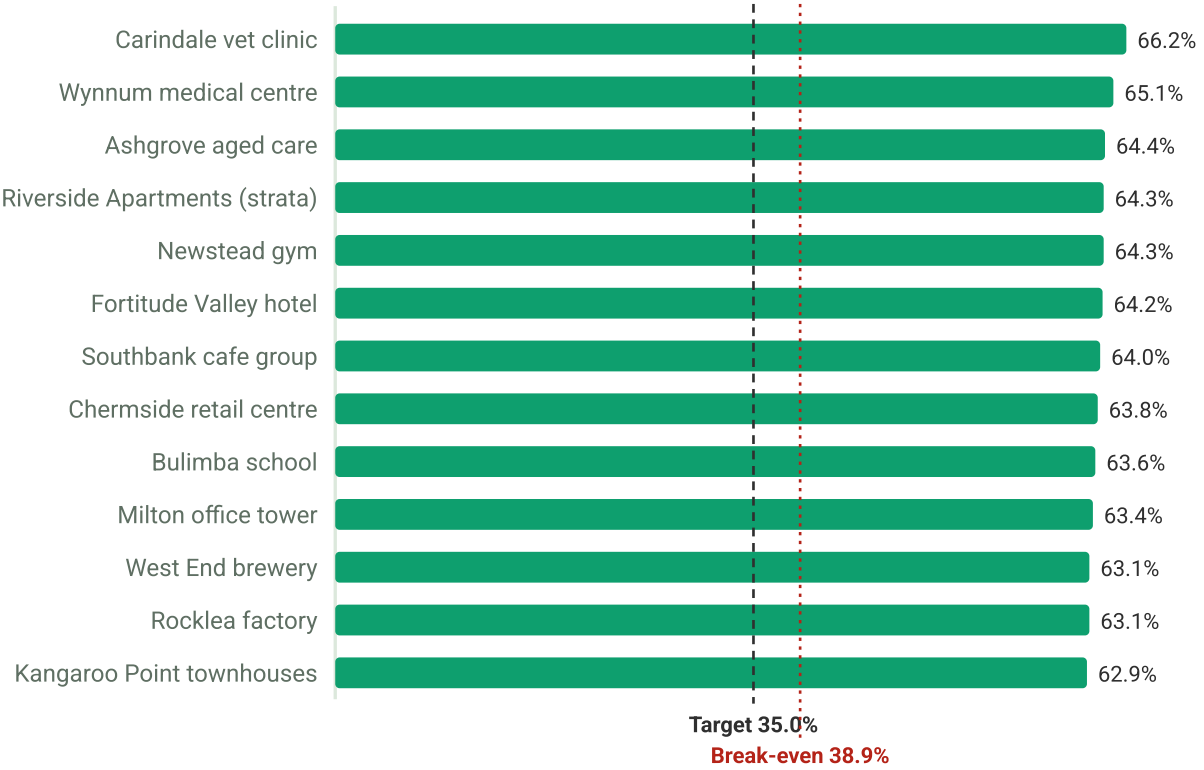
Job gross margin, March · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, February · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

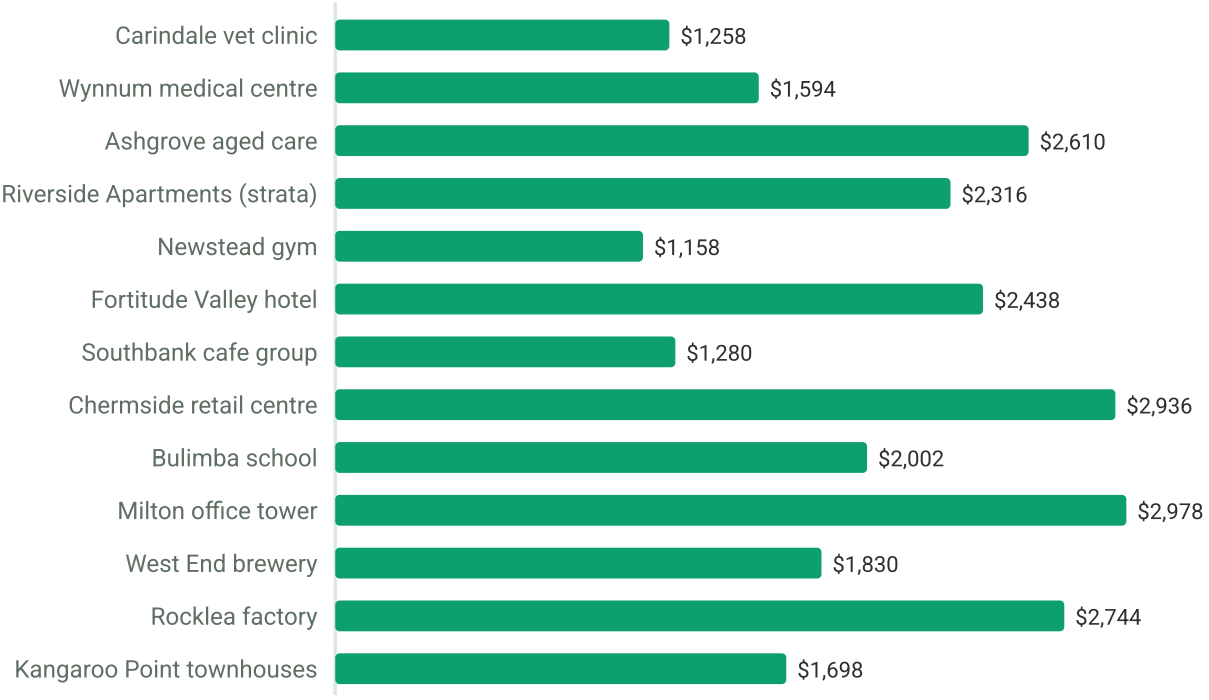
Gross margin jobs need to break even
38.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (March)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, March 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 13 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in March). All maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($12,142 ahead on $42,000 in March).

Type of job: Installations

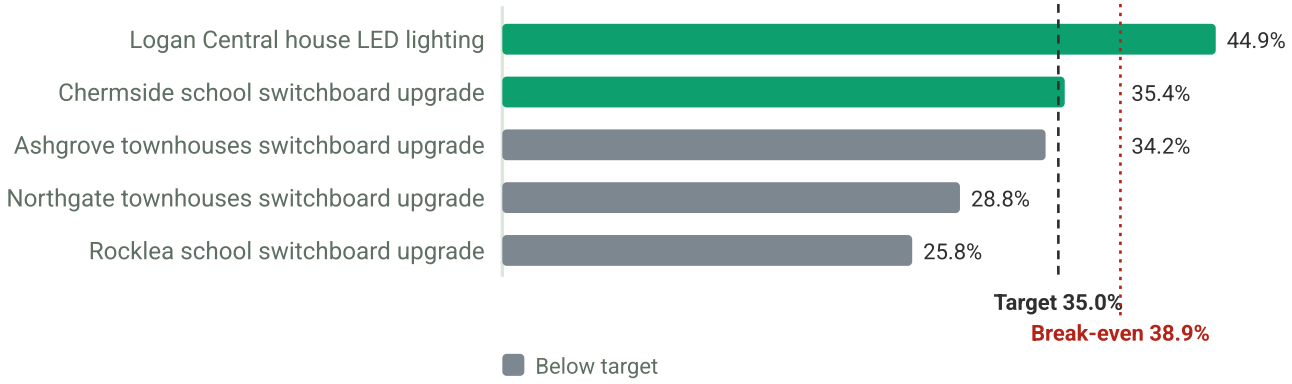
Job gross margin, March · Installations
34.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, February · Installations
38.6%
target 35.0%

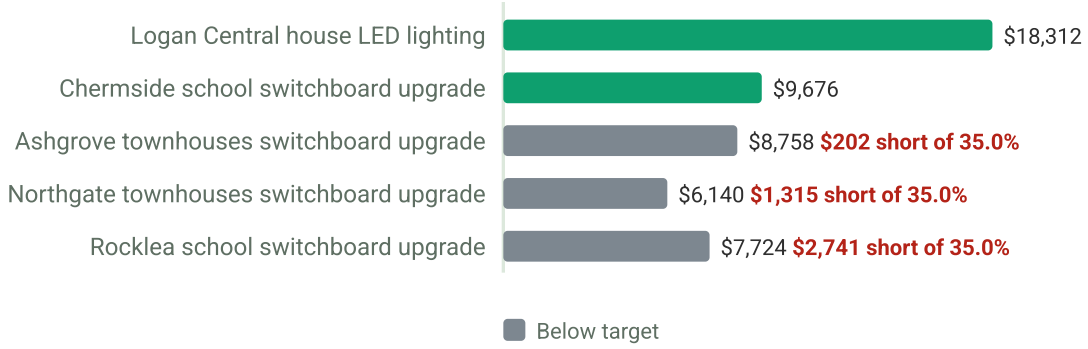
Gross margin jobs need to break even
38.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (March)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in March 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

3 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in March made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Rocklea school switchboard upgrade made a 25.8% job gross margin: 107.0 h of technician time ($7,276) and $2,700 of subcontractors on a $29,900 job. Jobs need 38.9% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

3 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about $4,258 between them on $76,800 of revenue. The biggest gap, Rocklea school switchboard upgrade: 25.8% gross margin, 9.2 points under the 35.0% target: about $2,741 on $29,900 of revenue in March. It's below the 38.9% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

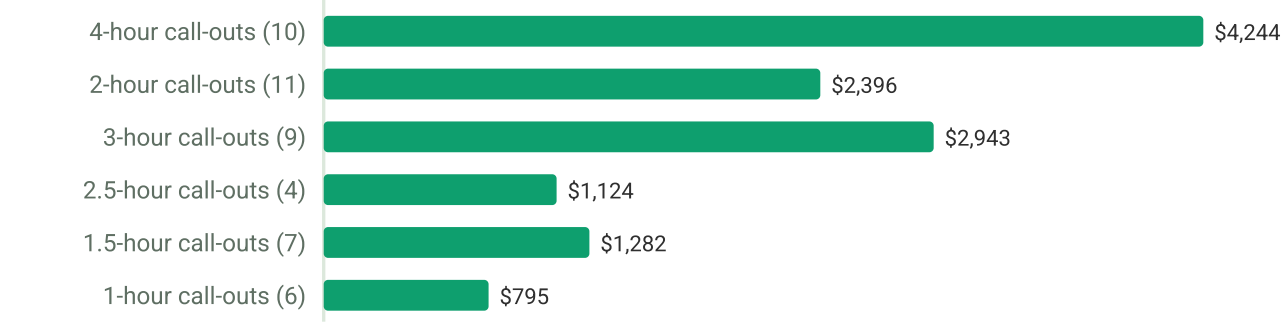
Job gross margin, March · Call-outs and repairs	Job gross margin, February · Call-outs and repairs	Gross margin jobs need to break even	Technician time charged, March	Materials charged, March
47.9%	**48.3%**	**38.9%**	**$18,826**	**$7,852**
target 35.0%	target 35.0%	covers overheads and time not charged (March)	70.6% of call-out revenue	$6,040 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, March 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

47 call-outs in March billed $18,826 of technician time and $7,852 of materials ($6,040 at cost plus 30%), and made a 47.9% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 40.7% to 50.3% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

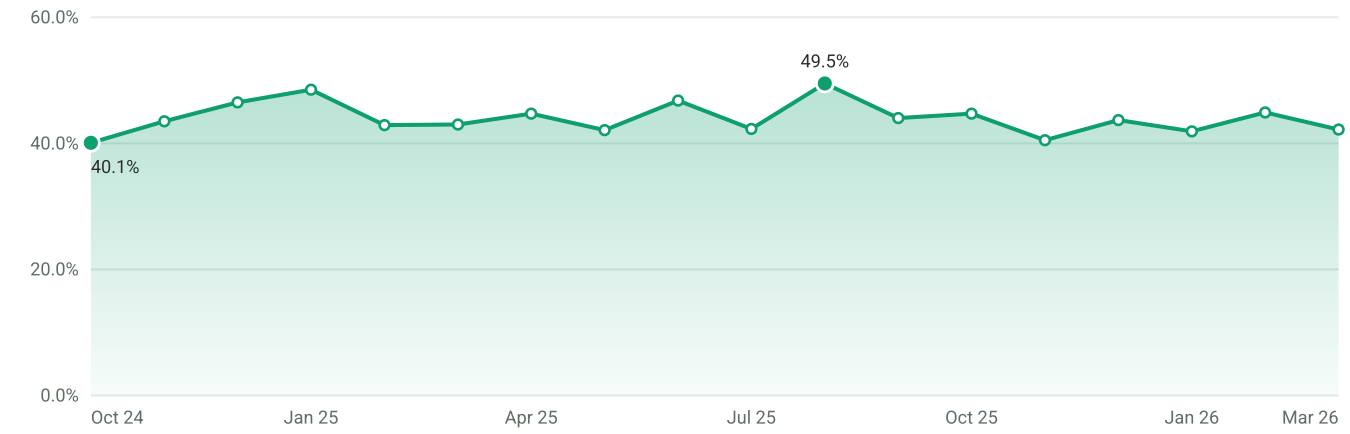
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 47.9% gross margin, 12.9 points over the 35.0% target ($3,447 ahead on $26,678 in March).

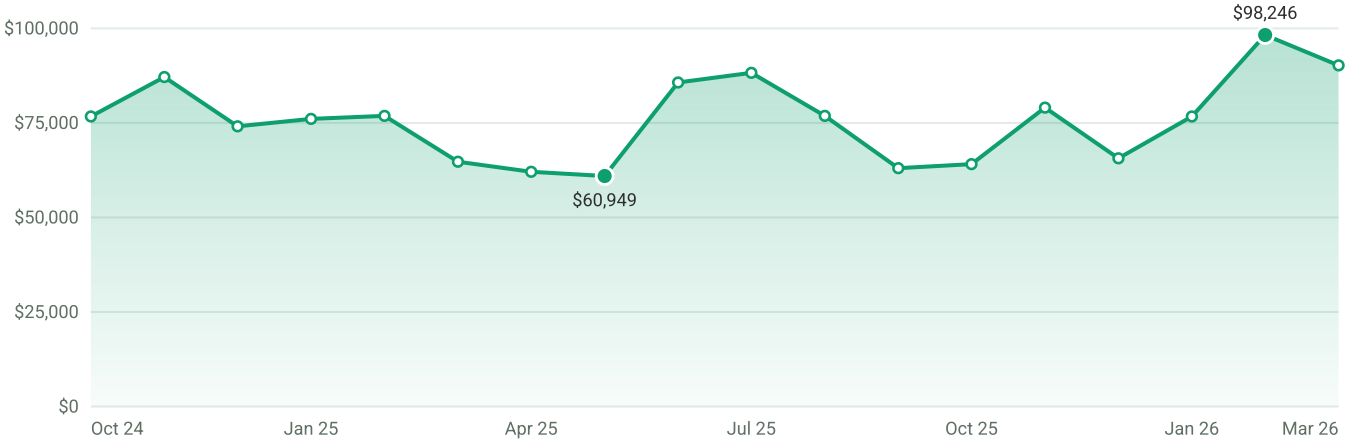
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.